Neutral source cards and method guidance

Tuesday 19 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W03

Pink paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

N1–N5 are wholly invented teaching materials about a fictional book display. They describe no real person or event. They are not survivor testimony, a composite or a model of anyone's Holocaust experience.

N1 An eyewitness account of a book display

Invented everyday account only

Fictional event: 6 October 2026. Account recorded: 20 October 2026.

I stood by the door as we set out books. I saw three boxes brought to the table. I remember a green cloth. I left before the display opened. I think it opened at ten, but I did not check a clock.

The fictional witness helped set up the display. The account uses first-person words written by the lesson author. No real person is quoted.

Think: Which claims concern what the witness saw? Which claim is uncertain or outside their view?

N2 How the account was recorded

Invented recording context

20 October 2026, fourteen days after the fictional event

A note-taker asked the volunteer what they remembered about setting up the display. The aim was a short club newsletter. The note-taker wrote the answer down. The volunteer checked the wording. No sound recording is supplied.

This tells us the maker, recorder, date and purpose within the invented scenario. An account may have more than one person involved in its creation.

Think: How could the question, purpose and time gap shape what was included?

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N3 A plan made before the display

Invented planning note

5 October 2026, before the fictional event

The display organiser planned four boxes of books, a green cloth and an opening time of 10:00. This note records what was intended. It does not record what actually happened.

A plan is useful evidence of an aim. It cannot by itself settle a claim about the event.

Think: Does the plan prove that four boxes arrived or the display opened at ten?

N4 A setup log made that day

Invented event record

6 October 2026, written just after setup

A different helper recorded three boxes, a blue cloth and an opening time of 10:05. The helper wrote from their own checks, without using the volunteer’s later account. The helper stayed until the display opened.

Within the fiction this record has a separate origin and closer timing. It supports some claims and differs on others. A log can still contain an error.

Think: Which detail agrees with N1? Which details need more checking?

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N5 A later newsletter note

Invented note based on N1

21 October 2026

The newsletter writer used N1 to describe three boxes and a green cloth. The writer did not attend the display and made no separate check. This note repeats the same account.

Agreement is not independent confirmation when one source copies another. Trace where a claim came from.

Think: Are N1 and N5 two separate eyewitness accounts?

G1 Using the questions with care

General method guidance only — no survivor account

Discussion guidance, not historical testimony

Survivor testimony can preserve a person’s voice and perspective. Recordings may support remembrance, education or research. Check the actual purpose and recording context. Historians compare specific claims with documents and other independent evidence. One account cannot tell every person’s story.

Consider memory and time without assuming a later account is false. A missing document does not by itself disprove an account. Listen without mockery or judging truth by emotion.

Think: What would you want to know about a recording before using it? How can careful questions and respect work together?